

Attention is a choice

A familiar walk can feel entirely different when you decide to notice just one thing: the light on the windows, the sounds between passing cars, or the plants growing through cracks in the pavement.

The street has not changed. Your attention has.

A question gives attention somewhere to land.

Reading works in much the same way. Before opening a page, try asking a small question: What is the writer trying to explain? Which part connects to something I already know?

A question does not have to be clever to be useful. It only has to give you a reason to stay with a sentence a little longer. Understanding often begins with noticing what you do not yet understand.

Pause before you continue

Choose one sentence on this page. What makes it feel important, surprising, or unclear? Keep that question with you as you turn the page.

Two ways to read

Sometimes we read to find a specific answer. Sometimes we read to discover a question worth asking. These are different activities, and both are valuable.

Reading to find	Reading to explore
Begin with a specific question	Begin with curiosity
Look for relevant passages	Notice surprising passages
Stop when you have an answer	Pause when a new question appears

The useful skill is not choosing one forever. It is recognizing which kind of reading the moment calls for. A search can become an exploration when a surprising passage appears. An exploration can become a search when a precise question takes shape.

Leave a small trace

A note is not a miniature version of everything you read. It is a trace of an encounter between the text and your thinking: one sentence, one connection, or one unresolved question.

A small reading experiment

Use this page to try Gamma Reader's PDF navigation and reading assistant. The experiment takes only a few minutes.

1. Return to page 1 and choose one sentence.
2. Ask the assistant to explain that sentence in simpler words.
3. Search this PDF for *question* and compare the matching passages.
4. Open *Reading notes.md* and ask how its note-taking structure relates to this essay.
5. Ask the assistant to save your conclusion as a new Markdown file.

A useful reading session can end with a better question.

You do not need to resolve every difference immediately. Keep the source close, return to the surrounding passage, and leave enough room to change your mind.